



David Simchi-Levi
Professor of Engineering Systems
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
77 Massachusetts Avenue, E17-459
Cambridge, MA 02139
P: 617-253-6160
F: 617-324-2546
dslevi@mit.edu

Jan 1st, 2026

Dear DAIS Best Student Paper Competition Committee Chairs,

I am writing to verify the eligibility of the paper submitted by my PhD student, **Ruicheng Ao** (MIT, aorc@mit.edu), for the **2026 DAIS Track Best Student Paper Award**.

The submitted paper is titled: **“Data-Driven Threshold Scheduling for LLM Inference: Preventing Memory Eviction Cascades”**

The co-authors on this work are:

- **Ruicheng Ao** (Student, MIT)
- **Gan Luo** (Peking University)
- **David Simchi-Levi** (MIT)
- **Xinshang Wang** (Alibaba Group)

Per the competition’s eligibility requirements, I hereby affirm the following:

1. **Student Contribution:** The majority of the original results presented in this paper were contributed by the student, **Ruicheng Ao**. He is the first author and the primary driver of this research.
2. **Student Status:** Ruicheng Ao is currently a full-time PhD student at MIT and is a student member of IISE and the DAIS division.
3. **Originality & Exclusivity:** This paper presents original research results. It has **not** been accepted for publication elsewhere at the time of submission, nor has it been simultaneously submitted to other competitions at the 2026 IISE Annual Conference.

Therefore, this submission meets all eligibility requirements for the competition.

Specifically, I serve as his PhD faculty advisor and certify that Ruicheng Ao’s share of contribution to the paper exceeds 50%.

Sincerely Yours,

David Simchi-Levi

Ruicheng Ao

Institute of Data, Systems and Society,
MIT

Institute of Data, Systems and Society,
MIT